

WENZHE XU

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EDUCATION

Goldsmiths, University of London (QS 11 Art and Design, 2019) MA in Design: Expanded Practice - Service & Innovation Design	London, GB Jul 2017 - Mar 2019
University of Amsterdam Digital Methods Summer School, Addressing Algorithmic Bias	Amsterdam, NL Jul 2018
New York University Paris Exchange Program, Defuturing/Refuturing Cities	Paris, FR Apr 2018 - Jun 2018
WeiFang University (Department of Mechanical-electronic Engineering) BEng in Industrial Design (GPA: 86.41/100, Rank: 1/63) • Core Courses: Principle for Product Design (91), Design Psychology (90), Product Form Design (92), Model Making (Excellent), C Language Programming (94), Multimedia Display and Fabrication (94), Pro/E Product Design (96), Three-dimensional Constitution (92)	WeiFang, CN Sep 2011 - Jun 2015

AWARDS AND HONORS

- **Provincial Excellent Graduates Award** (Top 1% provincewide), Human Resources & Social Security Department of Shandong Province, 2015
- **Excellent Graduates Award** (Top 1), Weifang University, 2015
- **Scholarship Award**, Weifang University, 2012/2013/2014
- **Excellent Students Leader Award** (Top 1), Weifang University, 2012
- **National 2nd Prize**, 8th National Information Technology Application Competition, Chinese Ministry of Education, 2013
- **Most Valuable Employee Award**, Black Lake Technologies, 2023/2024

WORK EXPERIENCE

Asia Pulp & Paper Co., Ltd., Sinar Mas Group Product Designer, Global Digital Center • Designed the in-house digital transformation system for the global sales center, communicated with Indonesian team and Thai team by English	Shanghai, CN Apr 2025 - Jul 2025
51 JOB Co., Ltd. Product Designer, UED Center • Improved HR-facing user flows, including login, job management, and job posting	Shanghai, CN Dec 2024 - Feb 2025
Black Lake Technologies Co., Ltd. UED Leader, Intelligent Manufacturing R&D Center • Optimized the user experience of the BL Manufacturing Execution System, integrated the BL design components • Established team collaboration workflows and templates for field-research itineraries and issue tracking	Shanghai, CN May 2022 - Nov 2024
Fullspeed Technologies Co., Ltd. UX Designer, UED Center • Led design bidding (proposal writing, bid presentations) for top-tier institutions and enterprises including Alibaba, Tencent, ZhongAn Insurance, and ZheJiang University, etc., executed full-case ux design, promoted to senior designer in one year and managed the ux team.	Hangzhou, China May 2019 - Jan 2022

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

BlackLake Warehouse Management System (WMS) for Unifree Co. UX Designer, Team Leader <i>Optimized the interact workflow for the warehouse operator of Unifree in the WMS.</i> • Assembled a multidisciplinary team to investigate usage scenarios at the Hefei Unifree factory, drew user journeys map, and prioritize solutions	Shanghai, CN May 2023 - Aug 2023
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- Develop design guidelines based on product features of Black Lake
- Shortened the operation time of warehouse workers by half. Received the 2023 Best Partner Award by Unifree

BlackLake Smart Manufacturing Execution System (MES) for A.O. Smith Co.

UX Designer, Team Leader

Shanghai, CN

Jul 2022 - Oct 2022

An investigation into workers' use habits in the A.O. Smith gas water heater factory found that the MES's terminal which is vertical mobile device mode affecting the workers' efficiency at fixed workstations.

- Conducted focus group and co-design workshop to define the new interaction mode, developed a landscape-mode interface integrated with an external scanner
- Proofread the interface primary color based on Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) standards, and added multimodal feedback, including audio and vibration
- Established a PM-UX/UI-Dev-QA workflow that doubled designers' available time without delaying the launch. Received the 2023 Most Valuable Employee Award.

Game Design for Alibaba Co.

Product Manager, UX designer

Hangzhou, CN

Mar 2021 - Jun 2021

Designed a real-time game based on behavioral design principle (engagement loop) to enhance user engagement.

- Wrote the game's worldview, and defined the scenarios, characters and character upgrade strategy
- Optimized the user experience based on first-phase launch data, increasing daily active users by 30%

Temporary Autonomous Museum

Final Project (MA), Supervisor: Duncan Fairfax

London, GB

Sep 2018 - Dec 2018

Utilized tools such as stakeholder maps and service design blueprints and applied service design research methods, a temporary autonomous museum was constructed at the Leake Street Arches, with the aim of provoking visitors to reflect on their relationship with physical space, facilitating the artistic expression of the artists in the graffiti tunnels and driving the traffic of merchants.

- Produced prototype in the form of a temporary museum (Key elements in the exhibition - graffiti, curator, ticket, audience and security) and verified the prototype in the field

University of Amsterdam

Digital Methods Summer School, Addressing Algorithmic Bias

Amsterdam, NL

Jul 2018

Mapping war atrocities across platforms tracing Srebrenica on Instagram, Facebook, Twitter and YouTube.

- Learned how to scrapping with Python, and mapping with Gephi
- Received the highest score in the semester of extended study

E-waste

Solo, MA 3rd Term, Supervisor: Prof. Tony Fry, Duncan Fairfax

London, GB

Apr 2018 - Jun 2018

Inspired by Tony Fry's theory of defuturing, this project examined e-waste in everyday life and proposed repair-focused systems for a more sustainable future.

- Conducted desk research, focus groups, and field research across Paris to identify barriers to device repair, including high costs, long wait times, uncertain repair quality, and limited access to repair information
- Designed a system with a citywide repair-shop network, service network map, device teardown information, and digital repair guides to make repair more accessible

From opposites to unity & 'jump out of frame'

Team Work, MA 1st Term, Supervisor: Duncan Fairfax

London, GB

Oct 2017 - Dec 2017

Took Giacometti's Man Pointing and copper wire (a common building material) as dual exhibits, deconstructed the single valuation and narrative authority of traditional museums.

- Led a 4-person team, designed the exhibit logic, device concept, and display approach.
- Utilized a counter-rotating nested double-cylinder device, floor mirror to disrupt passive viewing.
- Received high praise from the tutor: successfully transformed theoretical criticism into embodied experience with clear installation logic. The project was selected as a course demonstration project.

SKILLS

- **Research Methods:** Systematic Review, Interview, Focus Group, Co-Creation Workshop
- **Tools:** SPSS, Python, Gephi
- **Design:** Figma, Sketch, Adobe Suite
- **Prototyping:** Rhino, Keyshot, Pro/E, Arduino
- **Coding:** Solidity